

tial amounts of power. Therefore, battery-operated smart devices like sensors and locks also get drained way sooner than in other wireless ecosystems.

## Bluetooth

Bluetooth as a protocol has many things going for it. For one, it's already baked into literally hundreds of products – from speaker docks to door locks. Also, it boasts a higher bandwidth than both ZigBee and Z-Wave (though admittedly lower than Wi-Fi). Then, there's the fact that it consumes far lesser power than Wi-Fi.

On the down side, Bluetooth has a rather limited range. This means that for those devices that need constant connection – like security systems and motion sensors, it would fall short. But there are reports that say that the latest Bluetooth version – called Bluetooth Low Energy or BLE can form a mesh network, thereby extending the range, making it more than a competition for Z-Wave and ZigBee. Also, since a central hub isn't required with Bluetooth, the convenience is admittedly high.



A convenient protocol

## Thread

Thread is a relatively new entrant among wireless protocols for smart household devices. The protocol comes from the Thread Group which was formed in July 2014. The founding members include Google's Nest Labs and Samsung Electronics. Such high pedigree, but how does it fare in the real world?



New kid on the block, holds a lot of promise

Over 250 devices can be connected on a Thread network. The lion share of the devices that can be connected to the network are battery-operated, meaning it's power consumption is seriously low.

It makes use of the same frequency and radio chips as ZigBee.

The idea is to bring a reliable low-power and self-healing network that is secure which will make connecting to more than 250 devices easy. To make things even better, they can also be connected to the Cloud to get ubiquitous access.